An incident took place during the ceremony: Rabin realized that Arafat had avoided signing the maps that were attached to the agreement and that formed an integral part of it. There was a sharp exchange, and the ceremony was suspended for half an hour. Arafat stood his ground, and there was fear that the agreement would not be signed. Mubarak, who from the beginning of the incident had not hid his anger toward Arafat, approached him and on live television (!) cursed him in Arabic and told him, “Sign, you dog!” with the whole world watching. Arafat gave in and signed.

Neither John Kerry of the United States, nor Laurent Fabius of France, nor Ban Ki-moon of the United Nations, can stand up to Abu Mazen or any other Palestinian leader and demand, “Sign, you dog!” But the Saudi king, the Egyptian president, the princes of the Gulf States, and others can. They not only have the ability to do so because they are among the financial backers of the Palestinian Authority, but more importantly, they have the moral authority as leaders of the Arab world. The event described here convinces me that were there to be negotiations involving Saudi Arabia, Egypt, Jordan, and the Gulf States, there is a reasonable chance that pressure from these participants would affect the Palestinians’ signing. Even if it didn’t, it would still be worth a try.

So what is the Arab Peace Initiative that was initiated by Saudi Arabia? [4]

> The Council of the League of Arab States at the Summit Level, at its 14th Ordinary Session:
>
> Reaffirms the resolution taken in June 1996 at the Cairo extraordinary Arab summit that *a just and comprehensive peace in the Middle East is the strategic option of the Arab countries*, to be achieved in accordance with international legality, and which would require a comparable commitment on the part of the Israeli government.
>
> Having listened to the statement made by his royal highness Prince Abdullah Bin Abdullaziz, the crown prince of the Kingdom of Saudi Arabia in which his highness presented his initiative, calling for full Israeli withdrawal from all the Arab territories occupied since June 1967, in implementation of Security Council Resolutions 242 and 338, reaffirmed by the Madrid Conference of 1991 and the land for peace principle, and Israel’s acceptance of an independent Palestinian state, with East Jerusalem as its capital, in return for the establishment of normal relations in the context of a comprehensive peace with Israel.
>
> Emanating from the conviction of the Arab countries that a military solution to the conflict will not achieve peace or provide security for the parties, the council:

1. Requests Israel to reconsider its policies and declare that a just peace is its strategic option as well.
2. Further calls upon Israel to affirm: